

Anuroop Dasgupta

PhD Candidate in Astrophysics | ESO-Chile / Universidad Diego Portales
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RESEARCH SNAPSHOT

My research asks how disks of gas and dust evolve into planetary systems, and what observable signatures trace that transformation. I am an observational astrophysicist working in high-angular-resolution astronomy, and I bring together data from millimeter to optical wavelengths: ALMA, VLT/ERIS, VLTI/GRAVITY, CHARA, and JWST: to study protoplanetary disks from their outer dust reservoirs down to sub-au inner regions. I build the reduction and modeling pipelines this work depends on, from high-contrast imaging and interferometric model fitting to time-domain survey searches for eruptive young stars. This work is grounded in hands-on observing and instrumentation: I have served as a night astronomer at La Silla and contribute to GRAVITY acquisition-camera development at Paranal, experience that shapes how I design observations and build the pipelines behind them. By combining imaging, spectroscopy, and interferometry across scales, I aim to connect the structure and evolution of disks to the companions and planets forming inside them.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Protoplanetary disk structure and evolution: sizes, substructure, multiplicity, and evolutionary stage (ALMA).
- Substellar companions and early planet formation: high-contrast imaging and interferometric detection of embedded companions.
- Inner disk structure, accretion, and clearing on sub-au scales with optical/infrared interferometry (VLTI/GRAVITY, CHARA).
- Time-domain surveys and eruptive young stars: systematic searches for FU Orionis outbursts and their disks.

EDUCATION

PhD in Astrophysics

European Southern Observatory & Universidad Diego Portales, Santiago, Chile

Structure and evolution of protoplanetary systems from infrared and millimeter observations, with an emphasis on high-angular-resolution interferometric studies of young stellar objects.

Supervisors: Dr. Lucas Cieza (UDP) & Dr. Aaron Labdon (ESO).

March 2024 – Present

M.Sc. in Physics

Presidency University, Kolkata, India

Specialization in astrophysics and cosmology.

2021 – Nov 2023

B.Sc. in Physics (Hons.)

Presidency University, Kolkata, India

2018 – Oct 2021

PUBLICATIONS

First Author 2 published · 2 to be submitted · 2 in preparation

- **Dasgupta, A.**, Labdon, A. *First K-band Interferometric Survey of Previously Unresolved Herbig Ae/Be Stars with VLTI/GRAVITY and CHARA*. To be submitted to A&A, 2026.
- **Dasgupta, A.**, Roy, N., Samui, S., Chatterjee, R., Bian, F. *Spatially Resolved Gas-Phase Metallicity Gradients in 382 MaNGA Low-Mass Galaxies: The Role of Concentration, Gas Velocity Dispersion, and Environment*. To be submitted to A&A, 2026.
- **Dasgupta, A.**, et al. *Systematic Search for FU Orionis Outbursts in ZTF: A Multi-Step Photometric Pipeline and New Candidates*. In prep.
- **Dasgupta, A.**, Cieza, L., et al. *A JWST-ALMA View of the FUor HBC 687*. In prep.
- **Dasgupta, A.**, Weber, P., Maio, F., et al. *Characterizing a New Companion Candidate Near V960 Mon*. *ApJL*, 2025. doi:10.3847/2041-8213/ade996 [ESO Press Release, July 2025]
- **Dasgupta, A.**, Cieza, L. A., Bhowmik, T., et al. *Size Distributions of Protoplanetary Disks in the Ophiuchus Molecular Cloud*. *ApJL*, 2025. doi:10.3847/2041-8213/adb03c

Contributing Author 3 published / submitted

- Bernardi, A., Zurlo, A., Lazzoni, C., Desidera, S., Mesa, D., Pérez, S., Nogueira, P. H., Barbato, D., **Dasgupta, A.** *SanDi-SHoP: Searching for Satellites'N'Disks with a Star-Hopping Program II. Spectrophotometric Analysis and Orbital Monitoring of Directly Imaged Companions*. Submitted to A&A.
- Lazzoni, C., Zurlo, A., Desidera, S., Bernardi, A., Pérez, S., Mesa, D., Barbato, D., Nogueira, P. H., **Dasgupta, A.**, et al. *SanDi-SHoP: Searching for Satellites'N'Disks with a Star-Hopping Program I*. *arXiv:2603.24796*, 2026. doi:10.48550/arXiv.2603.24796
- Orcajo, S., Cieza, L. A., Guilera, O. M., Pérez, S., González-Ruilova, C., Batalla-Falcon, G., Bhowmik, T., Chavan, P.,

CODE & SOFTWARE

2025 – Present

FU Orionis Discovery Pipeline — ZTF/ALeRCE
Python · end-to-end time-domain survey pipeline

Mines the full ZTF archive (~131 million sources, served via the ALeRCE broker) for FU Orionis accretion outbursts through a multi-stage selection cascade: detection and baseline cuts, WISE infrared colour selection of disk-bearing YSOs, amplitude and light-curve morphology criteria, and Lomb–Scargle vetting. Recovers all known ZTF-era FUors (Gaia18dvy, Gaia20bdk) and yields 245 vetted candidates, the largest uniformly selected FUor sample to date. Includes a real-time weekly monitor issuing automated alerts for Target-of-Opportunity follow-up, designed to be portable to the Rubin/LSST alert stream. (Repository to be released with the paper.)

2025 – Present

Temperature Gradient Disk Model — VLT/CHARA Interferometry
Python · interferometric + SED modeling

Physically motivated disk model that jointly fits spectrally dispersed near-infrared squared visibilities and the broadband SED, computing disk visibilities via the Hankel transform of a radial temperature profile. Combines Nelder–Mead optimisation with **emcee** MCMC for parameter estimation, with halo and compact-component extensions. Used to constrain inner rim temperatures, radii, and temperature gradients across the Herbig Ae/Be survey.

2024 – Present

ERIS/VLT L'-Band High-Contrast Imaging Pipeline
Python · ADI, PSF subtraction, sub-pixel astrometry

Dedicated angular differential imaging and PSF-subtraction pipeline with precision astrometric extraction for VLT/ERIS. Applied to V960 Mon, where it yielded the detection of a new substellar companion candidate (ApJL 2025).

2025 – Present

JWST MIRI MRS Reduction & Analysis Pipeline
Python · IFU spectral-cube reduction and diagnostics

Custom reduction and analysis layer built on the MINDS / **jwst** / VIP framework for MIRI MRS (5–28 μm) data of FUor stars. Resolves IFU-cube recentering failures via peak-finding on median-collapsed cubes, with extinction correction, multi-blackbody and spline continuum fitting, and dust/ice and outflow diagnostics (10 μm silicates, CO₂ ice, [Ne II], H₂).

PRESS COVERAGE

July 2025

ESO Press Release eso2513 — “Astronomers witness newborn planet sculpting the dust around it”
European Southern Observatory | first-author result

National/international release featuring my first-author study of V960 Mon (ApJL 2025); release imagery credited to ESO/A. Dasgupta.

May 2025

ALMA Press Release — “ALMA inspires new models of how planet-forming disks evolve”
Atacama Large Millimeter/submillimeter Array | co-author result

Release on the ODISEA unified evolutionary sequence of planet-driven disk substructures (Orcajo et al., ApJL 2025), on which I am a co-author.

ACCEPTED TELESCOPE PROPOSALS

Period	Role	Title
ESO P117 (2026)	CoI	ERIS/VLT: A Direct Test of Models Linking Disc Substructures to Planet Formation through Core Accretion
ESO P116 (2026)	CoI	GRAVITY/VLTI: Resolving the Inner Disks of a Complete Sample of Planet-Forming Disks
NTT/EFOSC2 (2026)	PI	Spectroscopic Classification of New Young Eruptive Star Candidates
ESO P115 (2024)	PI	VLT/VISIR: Formation and Distribution of Crystalline Material in Outbursting FUor Disks
ESO P115 (2024)	CoI	Searching for PDS 70 Analogues
ESO P114 (2024)	PI	Satellites & Circumplanetary Disks Around DI Companions via Star-Hopping (Cont.)
ESO P114 (2024)	CoI	First Survey of (Sub-)Stellar Companions Around Protostars (Part II)

CONFERENCES, TALKS & COLLOQUIA

Colloquia & Seminars: 4 · Talks & Posters: 9 (7 international, 2 national)

Jul 2026

Discs on the Exe, University of Exeter

Exeter, UK | V960 Mon: Ideal Laboratory for Gravitational Instability (talk); First Volume-Complete Survey on Nearby Herbig's with GRAVITY (poster)

May 2026

Eruptive Young Stars Workshop, Konkoly Observatory
Budapest, Hungary | JWST–ALMA View of HBC 687 (talk)

Feb 2026

Spirit of Lyot 6, Caltech

Pasadena, CA, USA | *V960 Mon: Ideal Laboratory for Gravitational Instability (poster)*

Nov 2025

Stellar Variability: Taking the Pulse of the Universe, IUCAA
Pune, India | *V960 Mon: Ideal Laboratory for Gravitational Instability (talk)*

Sep 2025

Indian Institute of Technology Bombay
Mumbai, India | *Planet Formation Across Different Wavelengths (invited)*

Sep 2025

UKI Discs Meeting, University of Hertfordshire
Hertfordshire, UK | *Complete Size Distribution for the 100 Brightest Protoplanetary Disks in Ophiuchus (talk)*

Oct 2025

IISER Kolkata
Kolkata, India | *Planet Formation Across Different Wavelengths (invited)*

Feb 2025

Circumplanetary Disks and Satellite Formation III
Kyoto, Japan | *Complete Size Distribution for the 100 Brightest Protoplanetary Disks in Ophiuchus (talk)*

Dec 2024

Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR)
Mumbai, India | *Size Distributions of Protoplanetary Disks in Nearby Star-Forming Regions (invited)*

Dec 2024

National Centre for Radio Astrophysics (NCRA)
Pune, India | *Size Distributions of Protoplanetary Disks in Nearby Star-Forming Regions (invited)*

Nov 2024

SOCHIAS XIX Meeting, Universidad de Tarapacá
Arica, Chile | *What is the Size Distribution of Disks in Nearby Star-Forming Regions? (contributed)*

Nov 2024

Unveiling the Origin of Brown Dwarfs, ESO
Santiago, Chile | *First Direct Observational Evidence of Gravitational Instability? (contributed)*

OBSERVING & INSTRUMENTATION

March 2026

Night Astronomer — NTT/EFOSC2, La Silla Observatory
ESO-Chile, La Silla, Chile

Conducted service observations over 10 nights, executing 13 approved ESO-Chile programs spanning optical imaging and low/medium-resolution spectroscopy, including target acquisition, real-time instrument operation, and quality control.

2025 – Present

GRAVITY Acquisition-Camera Photometry — VLTI/GRAVITY
ESO & UDP | instrument development

Developing reliable photometric calibration from the GRAVITY acquisition camera in dual-field mode, identifying NIR standards suitable for dual-field observations, preparing and executing test OBs, and assessing flux-calibration stability and accuracy, toward formalising acquisition-camera photometry as a standard science capability.

July 2025

Paranal Observatory — VLTI/GRAVITY Calibration
ESO, Atacama Desert, Chile

Participation in VLTI operations and GRAVITY instrument calibration.

Oct 2024

Swope Telescope Observing Run
Las Campanas Observatory, Chile

Multi-filter imaging; project on the metallicity–dynamics connection in galaxies.

SUPERVISION

2025 – Present

MSc Thesis Co-Supervisor — Srimoyree Mitra (St. Xavier’s College, Kolkata, India)
Universidad Diego Portales

“Evolution of Light Curves Across SED Classes in Protoplanetary Disks in the Taurus Molecular Cloud and the Effect of Multiplicity.” Multi-epoch photometric variability analysis across disk evolutionary stages.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Facilities

ALMA (Bands 6–8), VLT/ERIS, VLTI/GRAVITY, CHARA/MIRCX-MYSTIC, VLT/VISIR, JWST/MIRI, NTT/EFOSC2, Swope

Programming

Python (primary), Fortran, Mathematica, L^AT_EX, Bash; Git, test-driven development

Astro tools

CASA, PMOIRE, jwst/MINDS/VIP, Astropy, Specutils, emcee, IRAF, DS9, TOPCAT, Streamlit

Analysis

Interferometric visibility modeling · Bayesian inference / MCMC · Lomb–Scargle · multi-wavelength photometry (ZTF, WISE, 2MASS, Gaia, PanSTARRS) · spectral line fitting · bootstrap / Monte Carlo

Pipelines

End-to-end instrument-adaptable workflows; large-scale DB queries (SQL, ALeRCE API); automated real-time alert systems

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS & HONOURS

- **ANID Beca de Doctorado Nacional** (National Doctoral Fellowship) — Agencia Nacional de Investigación y Desarrollo (ANID), Chile, 2025.
- **ESO Studentship Programme** — European Southern Observatory, 2025–2027.
- **Outstanding Paper Award** — awarded for the best paper/presentation at the state level (West Bengal, India); 31st West Bengal State Science & Technology Congress, 2024.
- **Paramesh Chandra Bhattacharya Memorial Award** — Best Master’s thesis, Presidency University, 2023.
- **Academic Ranking** — ranked 3rd in M.Sc. semesters 3 & 4, Presidency University; ranked 14th/~1,000 in Pune University MSc entrance (declined).
- **Top 1% West Bengal State Board**, Class 10 & 12 (2018); selected for INSPIRE *Young Scientists Meet*, DST India, 2016.

OUTREACH

- Great Asteroid Festival (5th ed.) — AUI/NRAO/YEMS outreach stand, Las Vizcachas, Puente Alto, Chile (2026).
- Colloquium Host, ESO-Chile weekly colloquium programme (ongoing).
- “Exploring Exoplanets” (PME-funded, YEMS Millennium Nucleus “Astrophysics at School”) — developing an educational card game and activity book on exoplanets, disks, and Solar System moons for underserved communities (ongoing).
- Public telescope observations and guided eclipse viewing (Universidad Diego Portales); science communication and online seminars introducing astrophysics to students in India and Chile.

SCHOOLS & WORKSHOPS

Summer School in Astrophysics — Indian Institute of Astrophysics, Bangalore	2022
Summer Research Fellowship (High Energy Astrophysics) — IISER Bhopal	2022
International Capsule Workshop on Astrobiology — Indian Astrobiology Research Centre	2019

REFERENCES

Dr. Lucas Cieza

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Instituto de Estudios Astrofísicos, UDP
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Dr. Alice Zurlo

Assistant Professor
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